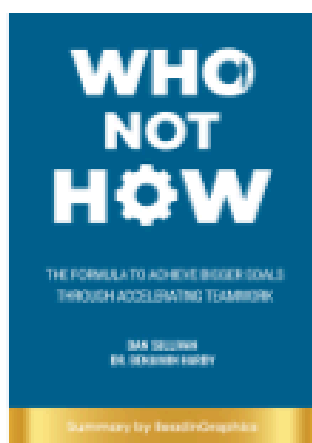




WHO NOT HOW

The Formula to Achieve Bigger Goals
Through Accelerating Teamwork

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The Big “So What”

Entrepreneurs and business leaders often ask the wrong questions and try to do everything themselves. They ask “How can we do this?” or “How do we achieve this goal?” instead of “Who can help us to achieve this?” or “Who can do this for us?”

By working with the right people, you can expand your vision, resources and personal growth to achieve dramatically better results.



Introduction



To succeed, you must put in effort and become great at what you do. However, if you try to do everything yourself, you'll end up diluting your energy/focus. The secret to true success and freedom is to focus your energy on the areas that leverage your strengths, creativity, and passions, so you can generate the greatest impact.



When you're stuck with a problem, do you find yourself asking “How can I do this?” This is the actually wrong approach.

- Stop asking questions like “How should I do this?” or “How should I achieve this goal?” When you focus on “how”, you're restricted to your finite time, resources, skills and experience.
- Instead, focus on “who” by asking “Who can help me to achieve this goal?” or “Who can do this for me?” Such questions immediately open up new possibilities that you wouldn't otherwise consider, allowing you to improve your results by 10x or even 100x.

KEY QUOTES

“This is a book about producing bigger and better results in the absolute most effective way possible—in the only way possible.”

“The only way to make your present better is by making your future bigger.”

“When you're trying to accomplish something challenging or difficult that you've never done before, you probably need a Who.”



Adopting the Who-Mindset



The “Who Not How” approach is not about exploiting others. It requires a fundamental shift in mindset and approach that positively transforms you and your Whos.

- The core idea is to build a collaborative network where each person can offer his/her unique strengths while leveraging others’ strengths. Everyone on this “team” is equally valuable regardless of what they offer, and can achieve their personal goals by contributing to the shared vision.
- Every Who needs other Whos. You rely on your Whos for their strengths/resources, while offering your strengths/resources to them in a symbiotic relationship. For example:
 - (i) This book is the result of the Who Not How approach. Sullivan is the cofounder of an entrepreneurial coaching company. Hardy suggested writing this book after hearing one of Sullivan’s talks. Sullivan provided the insights, while Hardy wrote the book and published it with the help of Tucker Max. Hardy and Max were Sullivan’s Who for this book, while Sullivan was their Who for expanding their entrepreneurial vision/goals.
 - (ii) IBCC Industries, an industrial parts manufacturer, had to relocate its manufacturing from China to India after the USA imposed new tariffs in 2018. By asking “who” questions (e.g. Who can help us to start manufacturing in India? Who can help us to find the ideal location to build our plants? Who can supply good scrap steel in India?), the CEO managed to shift their operations to India in 5 months, and generate >\$20 mil revenue from their new plant in 18 months.



Here are the key steps involved in finding the right “Who”:

FINDING THE RIGHT “WHO”



Definite Vision/Goal

Get clear on your vision and what you want (Impact Filter).



Communicate

Share your vision widely and gain clarity as you go.



Find your Whos

Ask “who can help me to achieve this?” Find people with the right fit.



Support your Whos

Engage/support them and let them decide on the Hows.

KEY QUOTES

“Every relationship can be viewed as teamwork, directed toward a purpose.”
—Buddha

KEY QUOTES

"Your vision helps your Whos, and, in turn, you become their Who, helping them achieve their vision and goals with you."

*"Only once you give yourself permission to stop trying to do it all, to stop saying yes to everyone, can you make your highest contribution toward the things that really matter."
—Greg McKeown*

- Get clear on what you want. Define a clear, non-negotiable vision. You can download Dan Sullivan's 1-page Impact Filter to crystallize your goals, including:
 - (i) *The project focus:*
 - Your purpose: what you want to accomplish and why.
 - The significance or impact of the project.
 - The ideal outcome or what the completed project looks like.
 - (ii) *Why you should take action:* Define the best-case scenario if you take action, and the worst-case scenario if you don't. You must sell the vision to yourself before you can sell it to others.
 - (iii) *The success criteria,* i.e. what must be true for this project to be considered "done".
- Communicate your vision widely. The more you share your Impact Filter, the more you'll crystallize your vision.
- Ask "who can help me to achieve this?" When you're crystal-clear on your vision and ideal Whos, the right people will find you. Remember: there are unlimited talents out there. You're looking for someone who (i) loves to do what you can't or don't want to do, and (ii) will achieve their goals by achieving yours.
- Once you've found your Who, focus on engaging and supporting them to realize the shared vision. Don't micromanage or dictate how things must be done. Give them the freedom to determine how to achieve the desired end-results.



In the next sections, you'll learn how you can embrace this philosophy to earn your freedom, and enjoy more time, more money, better relationships and a greater sense of purpose.



Gain the Freedom of Time

Each of us has only 24 hours a day. How well you master your time determines how much you can accomplish. **In order to do**

what you love and are great at, spend less time on the things you hate or are bad at, and tap on others' strengths/resources.



"Whos" allow you to expand exponentially



"Whos" allow you to get drastically better results.

- When you ask "how" questions, you're limited by your own knowledge/capabilities and your finite time/attention. When you do everything yourself, your progress is linear since you have no time/energy to expand your vision.
- When you ask "who" questions, you can grow your results exponentially because you can: (i) connect to new insights, knowledge, resources, and skills, (ii) partner with people who can achieve more results with less time/resources, (iii) have multiple Whos (who in turn have multiple Whos), and (iv) free up your own time to focus on more impactful tasks.



"Whos" allow you to expand as a person. Every human being has an innate desire to grow. A Who-mindset is about developing 2-way relationships for mutual learning and growth.

- When we partner with others, we gain both material resources (e.g. money, networks) and non-material resources (e.g. time, insights, encouragement). This expands our efficacy or our potential to produce desired results. For example, if you want to improve your fitness, it's more effective to engage a personal trainer (who can offer coaching and support) instead of just buying a gym membership.
- Seek to unlock your "Transforming Self", which is the highest level of psychological development according to psychologist Dr. Robert Kegan:
 - (i) The *Socializing Self* acts from fear, and does things to conform or gain approval from others.
 - (ii) The *Authoring Self* has an independent worldview, but is blind to personal biases and is stuck with a narrow perspective.

KEY QUOTES

"What is the ultimate quantification of success? For me, it's not how much time you spend doing what you love. It's how little time you spend doing what you hate."
—Casey Neistat

"'Who' expands your vision for what is possible, because you no longer see yourself as the sole means of achieving the result."

"Who Not How is about utilizing relationships, and being transformed by them."

"Resources not only expand your ability to produce results, but can have a transformational effect on you as a person—on your identity, worldview, and skill level."

- (iii) The *Transforming Self* has independent views, beliefs and goals. At the same time, you forge collaborative relationships to learn, grow and expand your perspectives/self-image. This unlocks synergy where the whole is greater than the sum of its parts.



"Whos" help you to overcome procrastination



Most people spend the bulk of their lives putting off important things. The more you procrastinate, the more you lose confidence in yourself and limit your own potential. Whos give you the confidence and energy to break the inertia.

- Procrastination usually sets in when we lack the confidence to do something. The more we put things off, the less confident (and more guilty) we feel, and the more we procrastinate. Eventually, we develop a negative self-image that narrows our ambition and possibilities.
- Procrastination is actually a form of wisdom, since it signals that you lack something to start on an important task. If you fret over *how* to do it, you'll just keep going in circles. Once you ask "who can help me to do this?" you'll suddenly feel relieved and energized to seek out people with the time, connections, skills and knowledge to address your problem.



However, people will only want to collaborate with you if they believe in your vision and how you can help them. That's why it's crucial to crystallize your vision and commit to your goals *before* you try to enroll others. Define the "whats" and "whys", then let your Whos define and execute their Hows.



You can find the right Whos in all aspects of your life, from your work/business to your health, interests, and relationships.

- In fact, you're already surrounded by Whos. Just think of the people you rely on daily, e.g. the postman, cab-driver, your kids' teachers, etc. You're also a Who to your spouse, friends, children, colleagues, and customers. How could your life improve if you increase the number and quality of Whos around you?

KEY QUOTES

"Procrastination is a psychological phenomenon that occurs when you really want something more for yourself, but you lack the knowledge and capability to do it."

"You can have everything in life you want, if you will just help other people get what they want."

"Your life is filled with Whos that serve specific and unique roles, enabling you to be and do what you otherwise could not."

- Use quarterly cycles to add Whos and improve your results. Every 90 days:
 - (i) Reflect on your top achievements in the past 90 days and what you're the most confident of.
 - (ii) Identify and eliminate the tasks that drain/distract you from your high-impact activities.
 - (iii) For the next 90 days, identify 5 projects that you're excited about *and* confident of making progress in. Crystallize your goals for those areas, then ask "Who can help me to achieve this?" Add at least 1 Who to help you in your 90-day goals.



Gain the Freedom of Money

With more Whos working on your goals, you'll have more time to focus on the things that you're good at. This allows you to **increase your earning capacity and eventually attain the Freedom of Money (i.e. having enough money to solve most problems).**



Time is Money



There are 2 types of problems in business:

- Technical problems refer to issues where you already know the answer and just need a way to get there (e.g. setting up a blog page). You can learn how to do it yourself, but it's better to find someone who (i) can do it better/faster and (ii) wants to do it. This solves your problem while giving the other person a desired opportunity.
- Adaptive problems refer to issues without a known answer. This is where you come in as the Who—to set the direction and act as the creator/innovator. These are the high-payoff activities which only you can solve with your vision, knowledge, and expertise.



Each of us has a finite amount of energy and attention. Every time you think about an issue or make a decision (however

KEY QUOTES

"You have to work less to make more money."

"Delegate everything except genius."

minor), you're depleting your reserves, until you end up with "decision fatigue". The key is to progressively delegate the unproductive activities so you free yourself up for creative, high-impact work.

- When you're not bogged down by the Hows, you can use the time/energy to prepare for important events (e.g. an important speech or presentation). You're also more likely to get in "flow", which is a peak-performance state where you can push your boundaries effortlessly and expand your skills and results.
- The more time you free up for high-impact activities, the more money you'll earn, allowing you to get more Whos and resources in a virtuous cycle. Imagine what it's like to have a Who to handle every aspect of your life (including someone to hire/find other Whos), so you can focus on the most rewarding activities that you love. For example, you may start by investing \$500 for someone to edit and post your podcasts online while you focus on developing quality content. As your traffic and revenue increase, you can invest more into marketing your podcasts, and even offer bonuses for achieving certain targets.



Adopt an investment-mindset, not a cost-mindset: (i) see each Who in terms of the potential value and personal growth they can bring, (ii) think strategically (instead of focusing on short-term transactions), and (iii) seek win-win opportunities (instead of worrying about what you may lose).

- The right Whos will multiply your results, grow your vision and open the door to new possibilities. For example, if you're the CEO of a company, it makes more sense to invest \$2,000 to have someone build your website than to try and do it yourself. Investing \$150,000 in a good sales manager is also well worth it if he can bring in \$1.5 mil more revenue each year.



Invest in your Vision and your Whos



The Pygmalion Effect refers to people's tendency to rise or fall to the standards that others expect of them. When you invest in your vision and surround yourself with people who're passionate about your goals, you'll push yourself to

KEY QUOTES

"Only those who value their time can become increasingly free in the realm of money."

"Until you free up your time, your mind will be caged. When you free up your time, you free up your mind."

"Whos, when selected properly to fit within your vision, are never a cost. Whos are an investment."

"Every time you invest yourself in something, you become more committed to it."

live up to their expectations and achieve real results. In the process, you become more committed and confident, making it easier to attract even more Whos. Likewise, your team members will also become more confident and committed each time they overcome obstacles to move closer to the goal/vision.



Delegate and engage people effectively.

- The Self-Determination Theory says that every human being is motivated by 3 psychological needs: competence, autonomy, and positive/meaningful relationships. By creating an environment that fulfill these needs, you can unlock your team's intrinsic motivation and increase their performance.
- Focus on the end-results instead of micro-managing the process. Give your Whos the flexibility and autonomy to decide on the Hows. Focus your energy on upholding high standards, and on providing clarity and encouragement. Transformational leaders invest in their people in 4 ways:
 - (i) They provide *individualized consideration* by valuing each person's unique contribution, listening for their needs/concerns, and offering empathy and support.
 - (ii) They offer *intellectual stimulation*, creativity and learning by challenging assumptions, inviting inputs, taking risks, and encouraging their team to do the same.
 - (iii) They provide *inspiration* by articulating a motivating and meaningful vision, challenging people to raise their standards, and building a sense of purpose and optimism.
 - (iv) They *role model* ethical behaviors to earn the trust and respect of their followers, such that people want to learn, grow, and support them to achieve their vision.
- However, autonomy without clarity or feedback will only create confusion and chaos. To delegate effectively, you need 3 ingredients:
 - (i) *Goal clarity*: provide a clear vision, define what "done" looks like, and set clear boundaries;

KEY QUOTES

"Support is attracted to purpose."

"Treat your employees as an investment, not a cost."

"You define the vision, find the Who or Whos, and let them create the result."

"The most useful thing you can do for other people is appreciate their value."

"Autonomy without clarity is ultimately a disaster."

- (ii) *Autonomy*: let people decide how to achieve the goal; and
- (iii) *Regular feedback*: provide direction/inputs where needed.



Gain the Freedom of Relationships

As you grow your Time and Money Freedoms, you'll meet world-class mentors and collaborators who can bring you and your products/services to even greater heights. You'll also have **the flexibility to connect/partner with people you want to build relationships with.**



Be a good "Who" to others first



Create value first. Transformational relationships only work if all parties are willing to ask "What's in it for *them*?" instead of "What's in it for *me*?" Before you approach someone, learn what they value or care about, and if/how you could help them to accomplish what they want. Only forge relationships if you have something concrete and meaningful to contribute. Ultimately, you want to work with people whose objectives can be met by helping you to achieve your vision.



Continually add value to others to build the relationship.

- Give generously and find ways to add value through growth/service. Seek to expand the pie for all parties involved. Don't focus on status or external rewards, or you'll lose the motivation to maintain the relationship once you reach a certain level of success or extract what you want from the relationship.
- If you're not used to connecting at that level, start by volunteering your time/services without expectation of reward.



Express gratitude regularly. All human beings want to feel appreciated. When you sincerely appreciate the people around you, (i) you'll feel happier and humbler, (ii) others

KEY QUOTES

*"When the student is ready, the teacher will appear."
—Buddha*

"Don't reach out to someone unless you have something meaningful to offer them."

"If you're useful, and continue being generous, the world will be very good to you."

"Gratitude attracts and creates abundance."

want to be around you, and (iii) you'll attract more Whos into your life.



Go for an ideal fit



Invest in relationships that have a good fit. Only connect with people you *want* to connect with. Ask yourself “How do I feel when I’m with this person?” The right people allow you to be who you are, and to become who you aspire to be. If a relationship is a chore, then let it go no matter how “successful” that person seems.



Be willing to say “no” to people who aren’t aligned with your goals. If a client is disrespectful, condescending, and insists on dictating the tasks of everyone on your team, let him go even if he’s worth millions of dollars. Only work with people who’re excited about your vision and can share an open, positive relationship with you.

- Always be the buyer, not the seller. Get crystal-clear about your vision, future self, and priorities, and only engage in relationships that are aligned with that desired future. As you gain more freedom of time and money, you’ll have more options and will no longer tolerate the people or things that you used to tolerate.
- Keep increasing the quality of people in your life to increase your confidence and likelihood of creating your desired future. Look back at yourself 5 or 10 years ago: How have your preferences, attitudes and priorities changed? What do you no longer tolerate?



Collaborate effectively

An effective team will always outperform an individual, no matter how brilliant he/she is. Even Tiger Woods—a golf superstar—needs the support of his coaches and caddy.



Be open to others’ ideas and suggestions. No matter how smart you are, your views and knowledge will always be limited. Combine your ideas, skills and perspectives with others to expand your possibilities and results exponentially.

KEY QUOTES

“When finding Whos, don’t settle...Find Whos that fit.”

“I don’t want to work on a relationship. I just want a relationship that works.”
—Dan Sullivan

“You get in life what you tolerate.”

“Your ability to succeed is based on the quality of the people in your life.”

“No matter how brilliant your mind or strategy, if you’re playing a solo game, you’ll always lose out to a team.”
—Reid Hoffman

 Create rapid feedback loops with the 80% rule.

- Don't try to perfect a plan on your own. It's much better to throw out your raw ideas or drafts to your team for feedback.
- Do what you can as the Who, the pass it on to the next Who. The last 20% of a project can be the most time-consuming. So, aim to reach 80% quickly (e.g. an initial draft), then get feedback from others, identify what's required to move it to 100%, and get the right Who to bring it to the next level.
- Don't let the desire for perfection hold you back from completing a project. Define the criteria for "done", celebrate a project when it's done and move on.

 Aim to be a hero to your team members and collaborators. This will motivate you to put in your best effort and achieve your best results. Likewise, allow others to be your hero—ask for help once you're stuck. When you open up, you release the pent-up emotions blocking your creative insights, and can get fresh ideas and perspectives.



Gain the Freedom of Purpose

Each time you add a Who with complementary strengths/resources and fresh perspectives, you address your gaps/weaknesses, free up your time/energy for what matters most, expand your vision, and increase your freedom of time, money and relationships. **You become truly free to pursue your dreams instead of getting stuck in the daily grind.**



Collaborate, don't compete



Shift from a mindset of scarcity to abundance. When you compete with others, you're pitting your finite strengths/resources against theirs. When you collaborate, you're adding others' strengths/resources to yours. This (i) increases your chances and levels of success, (ii) creates a deeper sense of meaning and belonging, and (iii) helps you to

KEY QUOTES

"Entrepreneurs base their lives on results. It's not about time or effort."

"Done is better than perfect."

"In the world of business and life, collaboration is the name of the game."

value others' contributions (instead over-valuing your own contributions).



Your identity, purpose and goals are shaped by your experiences and the people around you. Find the right Whos that broaden your vision and sense of purpose.

- British authors J. R. R. Tolkien and C. S. Lewis rocked the fantasy genre in the 20th century with their respective books *The Lord of the Rings* and *Chronicles of Narnia*. Without the authors' mutual support and encouragement, both books may not have been published.
 - (i) Tolkien met Lewis while teaching at Oxford University. They shared a common interest in Norse mythology and formed a literary group that met regularly.
 - (ii) Tolkien had been working on a poem for 4 years before he asked Lewis to review it. Lewis' praises, feedback and encouragement were instrumental to Tolkien's progress with *The Lord of the Rings*.
 - (iii) In the meantime, Tolkien and a common friend prodded Lewis to return to his Christian faith, which had a huge influence on the *Chronicles of Narnia* series.



Conclusion & Other Details in the Book



How far do you wish to achieve the freedom of time, money, relationship and purpose? Whose hero do you wish to be? Your level of success, impact and freedom will be directly proportional to how far you commit to and apply the points outlined above. Start by:

- Setting a bigger goal or vision for the future;
- Asking "Who can help me to do this?"; and
- Repeating the process for all aspects of your life.



The book also includes many real-life stories of famous people and entrepreneurs coached by Dan Sullivan. For more details, support and resources (including the free

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Impact Filter download), do visit www.strategiccoach.com/whonothow.

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KEY QUOTES